

THE AIR HOSTESS ARRIVES

A United Air Lines stewardess, modeling the new summer uniform, stands in salute beside a Douglas DC-3. The first stewardesses were introduced by Boeing Air Transport in 1930, and most other airlines followed suit. In 1935, when TWA switched from male flight attendants, it dubbed its new female staff "air hostesses." First seen as a reassuring presence, stewardesses soon became part of the glamour of flight.

controller might have to double as switchboard operator or baggage handler.

An answer was found in federal control of the airways. From 1936, aircraft using the airways under instrument-flying conditions had to file a flight plan with federal airway-traffic controllers. The pilots then had to report their time at various checkpoints along the route, allowing controllers to plot their courses by shifting markers on a map. The controllers issued instructions to ensure that the aircraft arrived in the vicinity of airports at different times and altitudes.

Pilots in the 1930s did not necessarily accept these new disciplines with good grace. It was by no means unknown for a pilot to decide he could not be bothered to wait any longer and simply take off or land without clearance. But, in time,

DUTIES OF A STEWARDESS

A manual prepared for stewardesses in 1930 included the following instructions:

- Remember at all times to retain the respectful reserve of the well-trained servant.
- Captains and cockpit crew will be treated with strict formality while in uniform. A rigid military salute will be rendered the captain and copilot as they go aboard.
- Punch each ticket at each point passed.
- Tag all baggage and check it on board.
- Use a small broom on the floor prior to every flight. Check the floor bolts on wicker seats to ensure they are securely fastened down.
- Swat flies in cabin after takeoff.
- Warn passengers against throwing lighted smoking butts or other objects out of the windows, particularly over populated areas.
- Carry a railroad timetable in case the plane is grounded somewhere. Stewardesses are expected to accompany stranded passengers to the railroad station.